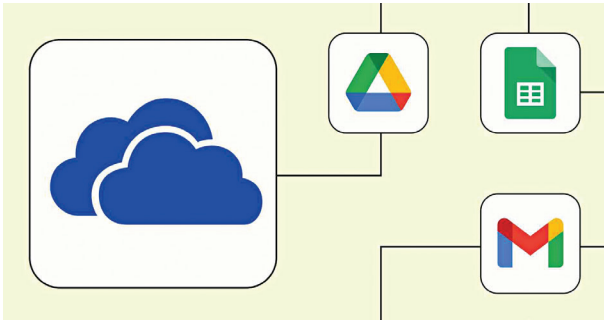




Microsoft's India pricing positions Microsoft 365 Basic at ₹149/month with 100GB OneDrive storage, Microsoft 365 Personal at ₹689/month, and Microsoft 365 Family at ₹819/month.

That does not automatically make the cheapest one the best, or the most expensive one the most complete. Cloud storage is not just about how many gigabytes you get. It is about what is being stored, how automatically it backs up, what devices it works best with, how it behaves in a family, and what rescue features exist when things go wrong. Google One is fundamentally attractive because your Google storage pool is shared across Drive, Gmail, Google Photos, and even WhatsApp backups in Google storage contexts. Apple's iCloud+ is strongest when your life is already spread across iPhone, iPad and Mac, because it combines device backups, iCloud Photos, iCloud Drive, and Apple-only privacy features such as Private Relay and Hide My Email. OneDrive becomes compelling when your digital life revolves around Windows, Office documents, and the idea that Desktop, Documents and Pictures should quietly survive a laptop disaster.

So let us stop thinking about storage as a commodity and start thinking about it as a fit problem.

Google One: For the Google-shaped life

Google One's biggest advantage is not merely price. It is familiarity. For millions of users, Google is already where their digital life accidentally lives. Photos go to Google Photos. Documents end up in Drive. Email attachments sit in Gmail. Android backup often leans on the Google account. The value proposition is brutally simple: one storage pool, one account, one upgrade path. Google's India plan page currently lists Lite 30GB at ₹59/month, Basic 100GB at ₹130/month, and Premium 2TB at ₹650/month, with family sharing available on qualifying plans.

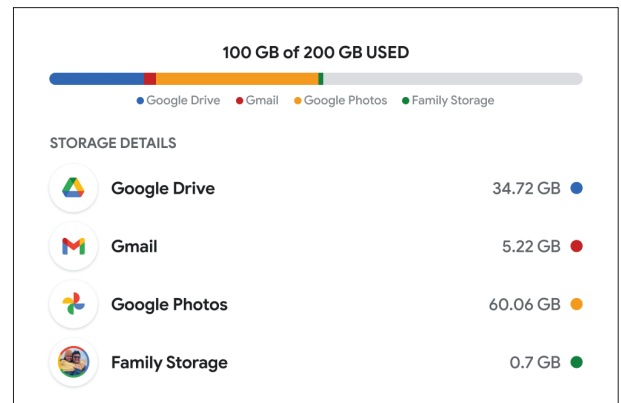
Google One is especially attractive for readers who:

- use Android phones as their primary cameras
- live inside Gmail and Drive
- want Google Photos backup without constant storage anxiety
- need to share a plan with family members
- do not care much about bundled desktop apps

The other reason Google One works well in India is behavioural, not technical. People already use Google accounts for everything. That lowers friction. A cloud plan you actually use

is worth more than a theoretically superior service you never fully configure. Google also makes it clear that storage is shared across Drive, Gmail, Google Photos, and related services, which is both a strength and a trap. It is a strength because one upgrade solves multiple problems at once. It is a trap because one bloated mailbox or one family member's photo hoarding can quietly eat the same pool that your backups depend on. Google's own support pages warn that when your account is full, it affects Drive, Gmail, Photos, and WhatsApp backups using Google storage.

That means Google One is ideal for the reader who wants a single paid layer across several Google services, but it is less ideal if you want strict separation between email storage, photo storage and file backup. It is also not the best choice if you are primarily paying to safeguard a Windows workflow and do not meaningfully live in Google Photos or Gmail. Google may still work, but it stops being elegant and starts becoming generic rented space.



Step-by-step: when to choose Google One

Choose Google One if most of the following are true:

1. Your primary phone is Android.
2. You already use Google Photos and Gmail heavily.
3. You want one storage pool for photos, files, email and device backup.
4. You may want to share the plan with family.
5. You do not need Word, Excel or PowerPoint subscriptions bundled in.

If you said yes to four or five of those, Google One is probably your cleanest fit.

iCloud+: Best fit for Apple households

iCloud+ is often misunderstood as "that thing you reluctantly buy because the iPhone keeps complaining." In reality, it is a fairly coherent package for Apple users. Apple's India page lists iCloud+ plans at 50GB for ₹75/month, 200GB for ₹219/month, 2TB for ₹749/month, 6TB for ₹2,999/month, and 12TB at even higher tiers. Apple also bundles features such as iCloud Private Relay, Hide My Email, custom email domain support, and